REALLY MANDARIN

☐ beginner

☑ intermediate

Story 10 November

珍珠的历史

The History of Pearls



珍珠是人类最早从大自然得到的“宝贝”，因为它是圆圆的，很光滑，也有自己的光亮。所以珍珠是人们最喜欢的宝贝。珍珠有很长的历史。在西方故事中，维纳斯在贝壳里出生，当贝壳打开时，她身上落下的水珠变成了珍珠。

其实，真正的故事是这样的：很久以前，人们在海边找贝类是为了吃里面的肉。他们打开贝壳的时候，发现里面有圆圆的、闪亮的东西，在阳光下非常好看。于是，人们认为这是上天给他们的礼物。就小心地把它放在头发里，或者衣服上，并把这些宝贝叫作“珍珠”。

原来，珍珠的形成，是因为砂子进入贝类的身体里，贝类为了保护自己，就不断地用自己身体里的东西把砂子包住，包了一层又一层。经过3到10年，就长成了一颗圆圆的珍珠。在人工养珍珠的技术发明之前，珍珠的形成全部靠运气。

古时候，住在海边的人们拿着篮子和长长的绳子，游到海底找贝壳，幸运的时候可以在贝壳里找到珍珠。但到海底找珍珠非常危险，因此，那时候人们得到的珍珠少极

Pearls are the earliest "treasures" humans obtained from nature. Because they are round, very smooth, and have their own luster, pearls are people's favorite treasures. Pearls have a long history. In Western stories, Venus was born in a seashell; when the seashell opened, the water drops falling from her body turned into pearls.

In fact, the real story is like this: long ago, people looked for shellfish by the sea in order to eat the meat inside. When they opened the shells, they found round, shiny things inside that looked very beautiful in the sunlight. Thus, people considered them a gift from heaven. They carefully placed them in their hair or on their clothes, and called these treasures "pearls."

It turns out that pearls are formed because sand enters the bodies of shellfish. To protect themselves, shellfish continuously use substances from inside their bodies to wrap around the sand, layer upon layer. After 3 to 10 years, a round pearl is formed. Before the invention of artificial pearl culturing technology, the formation of pearls depended entirely on luck.

In ancient times, people living by the sea took baskets and long ropes to swim to the seabed in search of shells; when lucky, they could find pearls inside. But searching for pearls on the seabed was extremely dangerous; **therefore**, the pearls people obtained at that time were **extremely few**. Now, people obtain pearls through culturing shellfish. This technology has made pearls increasingly

了。现在，人们通过养贝类得到珍珠，这种技术让珍珠变得越来越普遍了，价格也很便宜，普通人很容易就能买到。

common and their prices very cheap, so ordinary people can easily buy them.

重点词语 (Key Vocabulary)

HSK 3 NEW HSK 3.0

中文	拼音	英文	中文	拼音	英文
或者	huòzhě	or / alternative	放	fàng	to put / place
包	bāo	to wrap / pack	经过	jīngguò	through / process / pass
容易	róngyì	easy / simple	以前	yǐqián	before / ago

HSK 4

中文	拼音	英文	中文	拼音	英文
出生	chūshēng	to be born	原来	yuánlái	originally / turn out to be
普遍	pǔbiàn	common / widespread	价格	jiàgé	price
阳光	yángguāng	sunlight / sunshine	技术	jìshù	technology / skill

HSK 5

中文	拼音	英文	中文	拼音	英文
宝贝	bǎobèi	treasure / baby	圆	yuán	round / circular
运气	yùnqi	luck / fortune	不断	búduàn	continuously / unceasingly

语言点 (Language Points)

因此 (therefore / as a result - HSK4-08)

连词，表示因果关系，引出结果。 Conjunction used to indicate a cause-and-effect relationship, introducing the result.

> 例①：但到海底找珍珠非常危险，因此，那时候人们得到的珍珠少极了。
> *But searching for pearls on the seabed was extremely dangerous; therefore, the pearls people obtained at that time were extremely few.*
> 例②：兔子的耳朵又长又大，因此，它们能听到很远的声音。
> *Rabbits' ears are long and big; therefore, they can hear sounds from far away.*

极了 (extremely / exceedingly - HSK3-15)

结构：形容词/心理动词 + 极了。作为程度补语，表示达到了极高的程度。 Structure: Adjective/Psychological verb + 极了. Used as a degree complement to express an extreme degree.

> 例①：那时候人们得到的珍珠少极了。

> *The pearls people obtained at that time were extremely few.*
> 例②：那时候没有高铁，觉得上海远极了，要坐两天的火车。
> *Back then there were no high-speed trains, and Shanghai felt extremely far away, requiring a two-day train ride.*

练习 (Exercises)

1）在西方故事中，珍珠是怎么来的？

- ☐ A. 海水经过阳光照射变成了珍珠
- ☐ B. 维纳斯身上落下的水珠变成了珍珠
- ☐ C. 贝壳里的砂子变成了珍珠
- ☐ D. 人们把海里的石头做成了珍珠

2）珍珠是怎样在贝类身体里形成的？

- ☐ A. 贝类用身体里的东西一层一层地包住进入身体的砂子
- ☐ B. 贝类把海水变成了圆圆的东西
- ☐ C. 贝类吃掉砂子以后，身体就长出了珍珠
- ☐ D. 阳光照进贝壳以后，里面就出现了珍珠

3）古时候，人们为什么很难得到珍珠？

- ☐ A. 因为珍珠只在很远的海洋里出现
- ☐ B. 因为珍珠没有光亮，不容易被发现
- ☐ C. 因为珍珠很小，不能放在衣服上
- ☐ D. 因为到海底寻找珍珠非常危险，而且形成珍珠要靠运气

简答题 (Short Answer)

4）很久以前，人们最初打开贝壳是为了做什么？后来发现珍珠后，他们怎样使用珍珠？

5）为什么现在普通人也比较容易买到珍珠？

参考答案 (Answer Key)：

1. B　　2. A　　3. D
4. 他们最初是为了吃贝类里面的肉。发现珍珠后，就把它放在头发里或者衣服上。
5. 因为人们发明了人工养珍珠的技术，珍珠变得越来越普遍，价格也便宜了。